

English
Book Two
For the class XII

Sur Sasui

by

Shah Abdul Latif Bhitai



About the Author

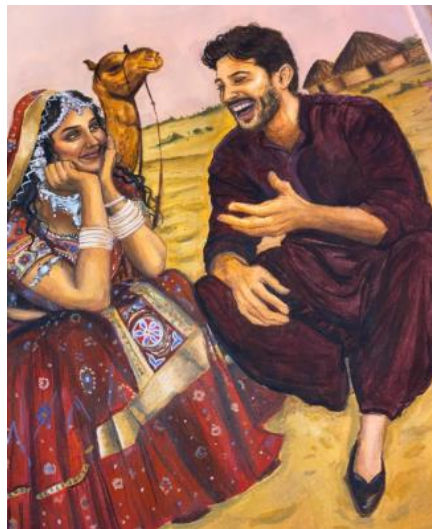
Name	Shah Abdul Latif Bhitai
Born & died	1689
Place of birth	1752
Profession	Renowned 18th-century Sindhi Sufi scholar, mystic, poet, and musician
Literary period	First half of the 18th century
Achievement	Composition of Shah Jo Risalo and Musical Innovation

The Poem

Type of work	Sufi poet, mystic, and scholar
Main Theme	Endurance in the Path of Divine Love (عشق میں استقامت)

Sassi Punnu

A Folktale



Theme of the poem:

The poem highlights that true (divine) love requires unwavering endurance, sacrifice, and the willingness to suffer in the quest for union with the beloved.

Short Question Answers

Q No1. How does the poet describe the physical and emotional pain of verse III?

Ans- Her love is so intense that **separation or forgetfulness equals death**. The mention of the desert's destructive force (blast) shows how fragile she feels without her beloved. This reflects that her suffering is not only physical but deeply emotional and spiritual.

Thus, the poet shows that **the pain of love is overwhelming**, where the heart's suffering surpasses bodily hardship, and remembrance of the beloved becomes essential for survival.

Q No2. What spiritual lesson can be drawn from the poet's portrayal of constant struggle and longing?

Ans- The poet teaches that true love, especially divine love, requires patience, struggle, and strong faith. The constant journey and pain show that one must not give up, even in difficult times. The longing for the beloved represents the soul's desire to reach God. The lesson is that success in spiritual life comes through endurance, sincerity, and continuous effort, not comfort or ease.

Q No3. How is Sasui's physical journey through the desert symbolic of an inner or spiritual journey?

Ans- Sasui's physical journey through the desert represents a spiritual journey towards the beloved. The desert symbolizes hardships, trials, and loneliness faced in life. Her continuous walking shows determination and faith despite pain. Just as she searches for her beloved, the human soul seeks closeness to God. The suffering she reflects purification of the soul, teaching that spiritual growth comes through patience, struggle, and unwavering devotion.

Q No4. How does Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai use natural elements like fire, rain, and desert to reflect emotional and spiritual states?

Ans- Natural elements are used as symbols of deep emotions and spiritual states. Fire represents intense love and inner pain burning in the heart. The desert shows hardship, loneliness, and the difficult path of life. Rain, in the form of tears, reflects sorrow and deep longing for the beloved. Through these elements, the poet shows that external nature mirrors inner feelings and the soul's spiritual struggle.

Q No5. What lesson does the poet convey about commitment to one's goal even in the face of suffering?

Ans- The poet teaches that true commitment means never giving up despite pain and hardship. Sasui continues her journey through the harsh desert without rest, showing strong determination. This reflects that one must stay focused on one's goal, even when the path is difficult. The lesson is that success and true love require patience, sacrifice, and unwavering dedication, and only those who remain steadfast can finally achieve their goals.

Q No6. How would you compare Sasui's quest to modern-day struggles for truth, meaning, or self-discovery? Can you relate to her in any way?

Ans- Sasui's quest is similar to modern struggles for truth and self-discovery. Today, people face confusion, pressure, and difficulties while searching for purpose and identity. Like Sasui, they must stay strong and keep moving despite challenges. Her journey teaches patience and determination. I can relate to her because, in life, we also face hardships, but by staying committed to our goals, we continue striving to find meaning and success.

Q No7. What is the unifying theme of all the verses of this selection?

Ans- The unifying theme of all the verses in *Sur Sasui* by *Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai* is **steadfast devotion in love despite suffering**. All the verses show Sasui's continuous struggle, pain, and longing for her beloved. Whether through fire, desert, or tears, the poet highlights that true love demands sacrifice, patience, and perseverance.

In a deeper Sufi sense, the theme reflects the **soul's journey toward God**, where hardships purify the heart and strengthen faith. Thus, the verses are united by the idea that **true love requires unwavering commitment and endurance**.

Literary Devices of the Poem:

1. Metaphor

A metaphor directly compares two unlike things.

- *"Fire of love within me burns"*
→ Love is compared to **fire**, suggesting intensity, pain, and passion.
- *"What I consider love was in truth fire's flames"*
→ Love is again metaphorically presented as **destructive fire**, not comfort.

2. Simile

A simile uses "like" or "as" to compare.

- *"Tears... fall like drops of rain"*
→ Tears are compared to **rain**, emphasizing abundance and sorrow.
- *"Desert blast... like desert lark's (end)"*
→ Suggests sudden destruction, comparing the speaker's fate to a fragile bird.

3. Symbolism

Objects or elements represent deeper meanings.

- **Desert** → Represents **hardship, loneliness, and spiritual trial**
- **Fire** → Symbol of **intense love, suffering, and purification**
- **Journey / Marching on** → Symbol of **spiritual quest or struggle for union with the beloved (God)**

4. Repetition

Repeating words or structures for emphasis.

- *"Whether hot or cold..."*
→ Repetition emphasizes that **conditions do not matter**—the journey must continue.

5. Allusion (Sufi Context)

An indirect reference to deeper spiritual ideas.

- The **beloved** is not just a human lover but refers to **Divine Beloved (God)** in Sufi poetry.
- The journey reflects the **Sufi path of عشق (divine love)**.

6. Hyperbole (Exaggeration)

Used to emphasize strong feelings.

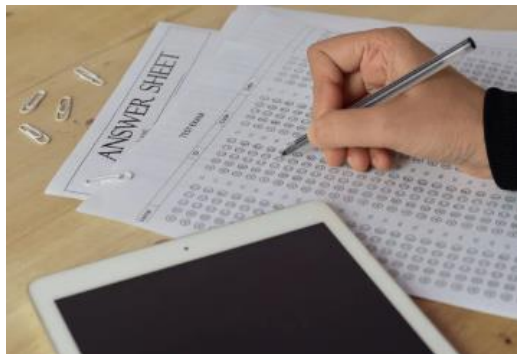
- *“Burn as long as you live”*
→ Exaggerates the idea of lifelong suffering in love.
- *“Burning in double flames”*
→ Intensifies emotional and spiritual pain.

8. Apostrophe

Addressing someone directly (often absent).

- *“Oh mother!”*
→ The speaker directly addresses her mother to express pain and struggle.

Relevant MCQs



Q1. What is the central idea of the poem?

- A. Celebration of nature's beauty
- B. Endurance in love and struggle
- C. Political freedom
- D. Social equality

Q2. What does the desert symbolize in the poem?

- A. Peace and comfort
- B. Wealth and success
- C. Hardship and loneliness
- D. Joy and celebration

Q3. What does fire represent in the poem?

- A. Physical warmth
- B. Destructive war
- C. Intense love and suffering
- D. Seasonal change

Q4. What is Sasui's attitude toward her journey?

- A. Fearful and confused
- B. Lazy and careless
- C. Determined and persistent
- D. Indifferent and relaxed

Q5. What does "tears like rain" suggest?

- A. Happiness and joy
- B. Continuous sorrow and grief
- C. Weather change
- D. Victory celebration

Q6. What is the spiritual meaning of Sasui's journey?

- A. Search for wealth
- B. Journey toward divine love
- C. Escape from society
- D. Political protest

Q7. What lesson does the poem mainly teach?

- A. Avoid hardship
- B. Success comes easily
- C. Love requires sacrifice and patience
- D. Life should be comfortable

Q8. What does forgetting the beloved signify?

- A. Freedom
- B. Spiritual death or loss
- C. Happiness
- D. Achievement

Q9. What literary device is used in "fire of love"?

- A. Simile
- B. Irony
- C. Metaphor
- D. Pun

Q10. Why does Sasui continue her journey despite suffering?

- A. She enjoys travel
- B. She is forced by others
- C. She is committed to her beloved
- D. She is lost without purpose

Answer Key with Explanations

Q1. What is the central idea of the poem?

✓ B. Endurance in love and struggle

Explanation: The poem focuses on patience, suffering, and persistence in love.

Q2. What does the desert symbolize in the poem?

✓ C. Hardship and loneliness

Explanation: The desert represents difficulty, isolation, and struggle in the journey.

Q3. What does fire represent in the poem?

✓ C. Intense love and suffering

Explanation: Fire symbolizes burning passion and emotional pain in love.

Q4. What is Sasui's attitude toward her journey?

✓ C. Determined and persistent

Explanation: Sasui continues her journey despite pain and hardship.

Q5. What does "tears like rain" suggest?

✓ B. Continuous sorrow and grief

Explanation: It shows deep sadness and endless emotional pain.

Q6. What is the spiritual meaning of Sasui's journey?

✓ B. Journey toward divine love

Explanation: It represents the soul's search for God.

Q7. What lesson does the poem mainly teach?

✓ C. Love requires sacrifice and patience

Explanation: True love demands endurance and struggle.

Q8. What does forgetting the beloved signify?

✓ B. Spiritual death or loss

Explanation: Losing memory of the beloved equals loss of spiritual life.

Q9. What literary device is used in “fire of love”?

✓ C. Metaphor

Explanation: Love is directly compared to fire.

Q10. Why does Sasui continue her journey despite suffering?

✓ C. She is committed to her beloved

Explanation: Her loyalty and devotion keep her moving forward.

